THE LAST TRAIN

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INT. COFFEE SHOP - MORNING

A warm, busy coffee shop in downtown Mumbai. Morning light streams through large windows. The place is half-full with office workers getting their morning fix.

SARAH (28, sharp-eyed journalist, always carrying a worn leather notebook) sits at a corner table, nursing a black coffee. She checks her phone anxiously.

RAHUL (32, quiet software engineer, glasses, perpetually disheveled) enters and scans the room. He spots Sarah and walks over.

RAHUL
(hesitant)
Sarah? I got your message. What's so urgent?

SARAH
Sit down. I found something. About the Westline Railway shutdown.

She slides her notebook across the table. Rahul picks it up, reads, and his expression changes.

RAHUL
This can't be real. These are internal memos.

SARAH
They're real. And if we don't move fast, everything gets buried.

CUT TO:

INT. RAHUL'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

A cramped one-bedroom apartment filled with computer monitors and stacks of old newspapers. Code scrolls across two screens.

Rahul sits at his desk, typing furiously. His phone buzzes. He ignores it.

On screen: a database query returning hundreds of financial records.

RAHUL
(to himself)
There it is. Follow the money.

He grabs his phone and calls Sarah.

RAHUL
Sarah, I found the account. The transfers match. We need to talk to Meera.

CUT TO:

INT. COFFEE SHOP - AFTERNOON

The same coffee shop, now quieter. Afternoon sun casts long shadows.

Sarah meets MEERA (45, railway union leader, weathered face, strong presence). They sit across from each other, tension palpable.

SARAH
Meera, the documents show someone inside the railway board approved the shutdown knowing it would displace 50,000 commuters. Was it you?

MEERA
(controlled anger)
I fought against that shutdown for three years. They went over my head.

Meera pulls out a thick folder from her bag and places it on the table.

MEERA
Here. Everything I have. Names, dates, approvals. Use it.

CUT TO:

EXT. WESTLINE TRAIN PLATFORM - EVENING

A deserted, aging train platform on the Westline route. Graffiti covers the walls. A single flickering fluorescent light illuminates the empty tracks. The platform is eerily

quiet.

Sarah walks along the platform alone, recording a voice memo on her phone. She photographs the abandoned ticket counter and the faded timetable.

SARAH
(into phone)
Westline Platform 3. October 15th. The last train ran six months ago. 50,000 daily commuters displaced. And nobody asked them.

A distant train horn echoes. Sarah looks down the tracks into the darkness.

CUT TO:

INT. NEWSROOM - MORNING

A bustling newspaper office. Phones ring, keyboards clatter. Newsprint and coffee cups cover every surface.

Sarah stands before VIKRAM (55, editor-in-chief, silver-haired, authoritative), presenting documents spread across his desk.

VIKRAM
Sarah, this implicates the transport minister. You understand what that means?

SARAH
I understand it means we do our job. I have sources, documents, financial trails.

VIKRAM
(long pause)
You have 48 hours. Get me one more source. Then we run it.

CUT TO:

EXT. STREET OUTSIDE NEWSROOM - MORNING

Sarah exits the newsroom building and walks quickly down a crowded street. She pulls out her phone.

SARAH
(on phone)
Rahul, Vikram gave us 48 hours. We need to find Kumar before they do.

She hails an auto-rickshaw and jumps in.

CUT TO:

INT. RAHUL'S APARTMENT - EVENING

Rahul's apartment, later that evening. Multiple monitors glow in the darkness. Documents and printouts cover every surface.

Sarah arrives, visibly tense. Rahul has a breakthrough on his screen.

RAHUL
I traced the shell companies. They all lead back to one person. Deputy Minister Kumar's brother-in-law.

SARAH
Can you prove it? Beyond the financial records?

RAHUL
I have server logs, email metadata, and three corroborating transactions.

Sarah stares at the screen, then at the documents on the wall. She picks up her notebook and begins writing furiously.

SARAH
We go to Meera's contact first thing tomorrow.

CUT TO:

INT. CENTRAL TRAIN STATION - AFTERNOON

The grand central station, massive and echoing. Crowds of commuters rush past.

Sarah and Meera walk side by side through the main hall. Meera points to a departures board.

MEERA
See that? Every route that was 'unprofitable' was serving working-class neighborhoods. The profitable routes to the new tech parks? All expanded.

SARAH
Transportation as class warfare.

MEERA
Not warfare. Erasure. You erase the route, you erase the community.

CUT TO:

INT. NEWSROOM - NIGHT

The newsroom is nearly empty. Just Sarah, Rahul, and Vikram remain. The story is laid out across Vikram's desk.

VIKRAM
(reading)
This is solid. Financial trail, three sources, documentary evidence.

SARAH
Meera's contact at the railway board confirmed everything. On the record.

VIKRAM
We run it. Front page. Tomorrow morning.

Sarah and Rahul exchange a look. Relief. Exhaustion. Purpose.

CUT TO:

EXT. WESTLINE TRAIN PLATFORM - DAWN

The same deserted platform from Scene 4. First light. Sarah stands alone on the platform, newspaper in hand. The front page headline reads: 'WESTLINE SHUTDOWN: THE HIDDEN BILLIONS.'

She folds the newspaper and places it on the empty bench. In the distance, the faint sound of a train horn.

Sarah smiles. She turns and walks away.

FADE OUT.

THE END